

Types of Controls

Estimated Reading time: 5 minutes

Objectives

After completing this reading, you will be able to:

- Align control functions with administrative control types.
- Align control functions with physical control types.
- Align control functions with technical control types.

Control types and functions

The following chart illustrates a few distinctive functions of administrative, physical, and technical controls. These controls are categorized based on their primary functions: preventive, detective, deterrent, and corrective. By aligning the control types with their respective functions, you can clearly understand how each measure contributes to safeguarding an organization's assets, information, and personnel.

	Preventive	Detective	Deterrent	Corrective
Administrative	• Policies for hiring and firing • Policies for data classification • Separation of duties • Mandatory vacation time	• Regular audits and reviews • Employee activity monitoring • Anonymous internal reporting systems	• Policies defining the personal consequences of policy violation • Security awareness training highlighting the potential risks and damages associated with policy violation	• Implement a business continuity plan • Implement an incident response (IR) plan
Physical	• Gates • Locks • Fences	• Surveillance cameras • Motion sensors • Environmental monitoring systems • Tamper detection devices	• Security guards • Reception desks • Lighting	• Repair broken controls • Deactivate and reissue lost or stolen access cards
Technical	• Antivirus software • Intrusion prevention systems • Multifactor authentication (MFA) • Firewalls • Access control lists (ACLs)	• Honeypots • Intrusion detection systems • Security information and event management (SIEM) systems	• Banners with legal warnings about unauthorized access • Code of conduct agreements	• Perform vulnerability patching • Quarantine detected viruses • Reboot the system

